AFDA CONFERENCE 2026

AFDA Continuum

Facilitating connected academic experiences across AFDA. A proposal for an expanded BCom pilot and cross-school exploration.

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ORIGINS

Grown from practical BCom workflows

Continuum explores how distinct activities connect through one unified AFDA environment.

- **Group Sync:** Balanced student team formation.
- **Schedule:** Assessment sessions and timeslot reservations.
- **Spaces & Resources:** Emerging venue and resource planning.
- **Assessment Marking:** Transitioning from paper rubrics and manual follow-up.



THE CHALLENGE

The coordination problem

One academic experience involves multiple fragmented processes. Current evidence is BCom-centric.

Team Dynamics
Form before assessments; complete assessments term-long.

Assessment Formats
Mix of individual, timed scheduling, and diverse markers.

Logistics & Admin
Venue planning and moving outcomes into formal records.



LANDSCAPE

Context & Benchmarks

Known from BCom

- **Microsoft Teams:** Meetings and class materials.
- **CARS:** Formal academic administration.
- **Group Sync:** Working team-formation tool.
- **Schedule:** Assessment session booking.
- **Spaces & Resources:** Requires further testing.

External Benchmarks

Reference only. No claim of AFDA adoption.

- **Moodle & Canvas:** LMS structures and digital assessment.
- **CATME:** Structured team formation.
- **CELCAT:** Timetabling and room management.
- **Microsoft Teams:** Assignment and rubric functions.

FUNCTION

Continuum's Role

AFDA Schools Retain:

- ✓ Curriculum
- ✓ Programmes
- ✓ Discipline structures
- ✓ Assessment design
- ✓ Rubric criteria
- ✓ Academic standards
- ✓ Final academic decisions

Continuum Coordinates:

- School workspaces
- Participants & access
- Teams & assessments
- Scheduling
- Spaces & resources
- Marking progress
- System connections

ARCHITECTURE

The Orchestration Model

Institutional configuration supports focused user experiences.

The Orchestrator Manages:

- Academic periods and school workspaces.
- Structures supplied by each school.
- Users, scoped access, and governance.

Students and Staff Access:

- Their relevant workspace and projects.
- Assigned assessments and booking tasks.
- Specific enabled services.



STARTING POINT

Expanded BCom Pilot

An established multidisciplinary model. BCom retains ownership of its curriculum and assessment decisions.

- One student from four disciplines per team.
- Team formation and membership connected.
- Assessments distributed across the term.
- Shared and individual discipline requirements.
- Lecturer, tutor, and marking progress tracked.



THE LARGER OPPORTUNITY

Cross-School Exploration

Participants Retain

- Home school identity.
- Programme and module context.
- Discipline identity.
- Academic responsibilities.

Shared Space Coordinates

- Project membership & access.
- Shared activity & scheduling.
- Venues and resource booking.
- Staff or external contributors.

Each school decides if and how a project connects to its formal curriculum.

FRAMEWORK

Defining the Collaboration Model

- Who may initiate or approve a cross-school project?
- How do students join or receive placement?
- Does participation connect to formal assessment?
- How do different calendars and schedules align?
- Which staff supervise or assess each contribution?
- How do outcomes return to the correct records?

FLEXIBILITY

Assessment & Marking Administration

Assessment Formats

- Individual student formats.
- Existing team structures.
- Ad hoc teams for specific assessments.
- Shared team criteria.
- Individual or discipline-specific criteria.

Continuum Coordinates

Staff: Lecturers & tutors.

Ad hoc: Internal markers.

External: Guest assessors.

Panels: Assessment boards.

Access: Limited period rights.

Track: Feedback progress.

Scheduling and venue data appear dynamically when timed sessions or physical spaces are required.

IMPLEMENTATION

Pilot Structure

BCom

Expanded pilot covering teams, assessments, marking, scheduling, and spaces.

Other Workspaces

Controlled access to established services addressing confirmed needs.

Spaces & Resources

Continued testing before operational use across schools.

Cross-School

Designed demonstration followed by approved pilot opportunity.

Existing applications remain independently usable. Multi-school use requires AFDA-approved infrastructure.

PROOF OF CONCEPT

An Actionable Experience

Orchestrator Setup

1. Configure institution and period.
2. Prepare school workspaces.
3. Enable appropriate applications.
4. Add fictional users and scoped roles.
5. Confirm workspace readiness.

User Experience

1. Sign in to relevant workspace.
2. View teams, assessments, and activity.
3. Open specific Continuum modules.
4. Complete relevant actions.
5. View responsibilities without role changes.

The orchestrator can preview all experiences while remaining signed in as administrator.

OUTCOMES

Evidence for future technology decisions

- Reduce repeated manual handoffs.
- Improve visibility across workflows.
- Clarify multiple assessor responsibilities.
- Manage temporary access strictly.
- Connect existing tools consistently.
- Facilitate cross-school collaboration.

Proposed Measures

Time

Required to configure assessments and allocate assessors.

Handoffs

Number of manual administrative handoffs.

Errors

Frequency of scheduling and booking errors.

Visibility

Tracking of outstanding marking and task completion.

NEXT STEPS

The Proposal to AFDA

Institutional discovery and a controlled pilot.

1. Run an expanded BCom Continuum pilot.
2. Allow interested schools to test services.
3. Nominate cross-departmental participants.
4. Confirm institutional systems and controls.
5. Identify one cross-school opportunity.
6. Define infrastructure, access and data needs.

"AFDA Continuum proposes a shared environment for facilitating academic experiences. BCom provides the established starting point. The wider opportunity lies in controlled service access and collaboration across AFDA's schools."

Image Sources



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